

EARNING ITS STRIPES



PLACE TO SPOT A TIGER ■ RANTHAMBORE, RAJASTHAN

When Mukesh Ambani, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh and US President Bill Clinton want to see a tiger, they go to Ranthambore National Park. With its plane topography, Ranthambore offers the best chance to see a tiger outside a zoo. A three hours' drive from Jaipur and well-connected by train, the park is surrounded by magnificent cliffs and creeks. Only government-approved vehicles are allowed entry. With a forest department permit, one can be driven right up to the edge of the cliff for a magnificent view of the villages located below. The three small lakes in the sanctuary attract migratory birds. The view from Jogi Mehal—an erstwhile royal lodge overlooking Padam Talab, a tiny pond—is breathtaking. One also gets a beautiful overview of the park from Ranthambore Fort, built in the 10th century, atop a steep creek. The best time to visit the park is between October and March. Not everyone is as lucky as the Ambanis, who got to see five tigers in one visit, but Ranthambore offers the best opportunity to spot tigers in the wild.

by Rohit Parihar

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OUTSIDE A ZOO.

